

Community Profile: Census Tract 5350162.00

This is a profile on census tract number 5350162.00 in Toronto, Ontario (see Figure 1). The tract is towards the northwest side of Toronto. The tract is part of the City of Toronto's Ward 12, Toronto-St. Paul's. The tract is part of the York neighborhood Oakwood Village. It is enclosed by Dufferin St., Rogers Rd., Oakwood Ave., and Vaughn Rd. The northwest corner of the tract intersects with Eglinton Ave. W. Census tract 5350162.00 hereafter will be nicknamed "Oakwood" or "the tract." The Toronto CMA region will be referred to as "Toronto" or "the city."



Figure 1. Map of Census Tract 5350162.00. (Source: StatCan).

Data Source

The data used in this profile comes from the Canadian Census for the years 2006 and 2021, courtesy of Statistics Canada. The data ranges from using 100% of the sample data to 25%.

Notes on Data

1. Income information in the census uses tax information from the previous year. The 2006 census uses tax information from 2005 and the 2021 census uses tax information from 2020.
2. Money figures from 2005/6 were adjusted to account for inflation by using the CPI percent change figure from 2006 to 2021, 29.87%.
3. For the variable “occupied private dwellings by period of construction”, the final category in the 2006 census is “2001 to 2006.” The 2021 census moves 2006 constructions to “2006 to 2010.”

Key Findings

- Oakwood population decreased slightly, while Toronto population increased
- Oakwood has an older population
- Less visible minorities live in the tract compared to Toronto, a difference that increased over time
- Visible minorities with a smaller proportion in Toronto live in higher proportions in tract
- Median income of households in Oakwood is less than Toronto
- Income distribution in tract has increased, more households earning a higher income and less earning a lower income
- There is less wealth inequity in the tract compared to the city
- In general, poverty indicators are the same in the tract and in the city
- Households with young children have less indication of poverty in Oakwood over Toronto
- Seniors who are 65+ have a higher indication of poverty in Oakwood over Toronto
- Unemployment rate is slightly less in the tract over the city; both rates almost doubled over time
- Comparing the tract to the city, a higher portion work in sales, construction, and the arts, a lower portion work senior positions, in business/finance, and in STEM
- Apartments with 5+ storeys were equally occupied in Oakwood and Toronto in 2006; over time, they became less occupied in the tract and low-rise buildings became more occupied
- Oakwood households majorly occupy dwellings built pre-1960, higher proportion than Toronto
- In 2021, more households started living in more recently constructed dwellings
- The average value of owned dwellings in the tract is consistently less than in Toronto
- Monthly rent is less on average and more stabilized in the tract over Toronto

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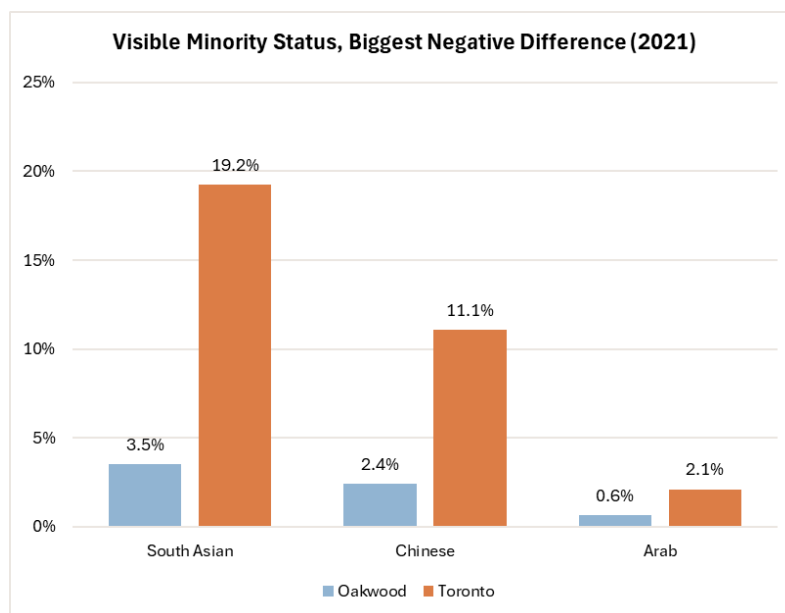
01 Population and Age

In 2021, the population of the tract was 4846 people. From 2006 to 2021, the population in Oakwood slightly decreased by 8.1% – the population in Toronto increased by 21.3%. From 2006 to 2021, the age distribution is similar in both regions, Oakwood veering slightly older. In 2021, the biggest cross-regional difference was that the tract had 58.6% more people in the 85 years and over category (3.4% tract vs 2.1% city). In 2006, Oakwood had an even larger portion of 85+ individuals compared to Toronto, a 244.1% difference (4.6% tract vs 1.3% city).

02 Visible Minorities

There are less visible minorities in Oakwood than Toronto. In 2021, the tract had 43.9% visible minorities while Toronto had 57.0%. In 2006, however, the portion was basically the same (41.2% in Oakwood, 42.9% in Toronto). Therefore, while the portion of visible minorities in the city increased drastically, the portion in the tract only increased a few points.

The distribution of visible minorities in Oakwood is very different from Toronto. Figure 2A shows that the groups that decreased drastically from Toronto to Oakwood are South Asian (-81.6% percent difference), Chinese (-78.4%), and Arab (-70.4%). Figure 2B shows that the groups that increased drastically are Latin American (181.6%), Filipino (111.2%), and Black (68.7%). These three groups also have the highest portions within visible minorities.



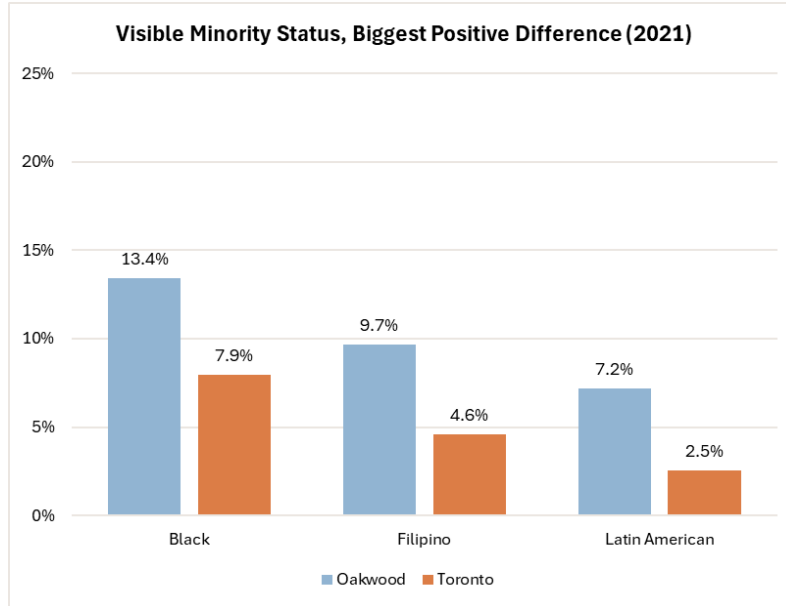


Figure 2. Visible minority status distribution in Oakwood and Toronto in 2021. **(A)** Top three biggest negative point difference (Oakwood < Toronto). **(B)** Top three biggest positive point difference (Oakwood > Toronto).

From 2006 to 2021, the Black population saw double the increase in the tract compared to Toronto. However, the Filipino population saw no change and the Latin American population saw a significant decrease in the tract and increases in the city.

03 Income and Poverty

03A Median Income

The 2021 median before-tax total income of households in Oakwood is \$77,000. This is \$20k less than the median in Toronto – a 20.6% decrease. After-tax numbers decrease inequity slightly, to a 17.1% decrease.

03B Income Distribution

Figure 3A shows how lower income groups in Oakwood have drastically decreased from 2006 to 2021. Compared to Figure 3B, the point difference in change for the income groups encompassing \$10k-39k is greater in the tract over the city. Figure 3A also shows the lower

income distribution that the medians suggest. Though those in the lower brackets have decreased, and in proportions larger than in Toronto, there remains a consistent inequality in Oakwood in 2021 compared to Toronto, veering to the lower income. The 20k-89k range of income encompasses 58.9% of the distribution in the tract; in the city, it is 48.2%. Excluding extremes, the largest group in the tract in 2021 is the 20k-29k group, at 10.7% of distribution. Toronto has no clear maximum income group because they are mostly equally distributed from 20k-89k.

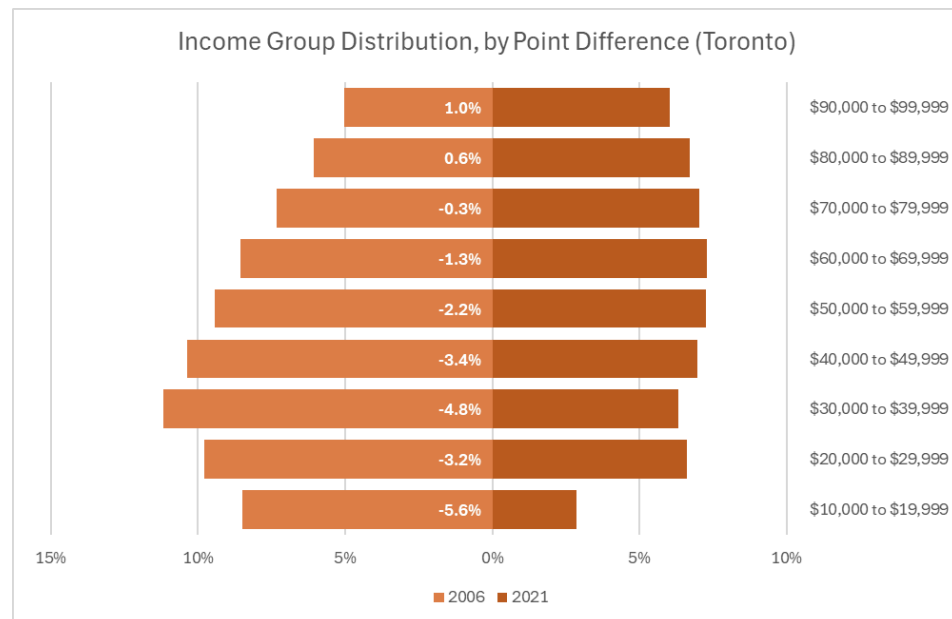
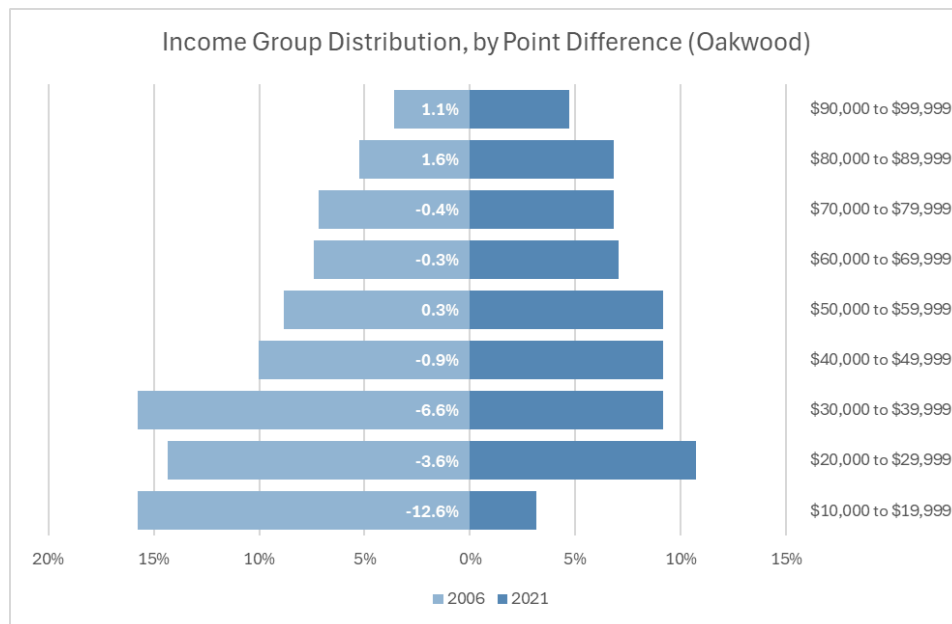


Figure 3. After-tax income group distribution for median categories, including the point difference, from 2006 to 2021. **(A)** In Oakwood. **(B)** In Toronto.

Now accounting for the extremes of the income groups, “100k and over” and “under 10k.” The 100k and over income group sees a significant increase in both the tract (31.9% of distribution) and the city (40.6%). Figure 4 illustrates this increase, as well as shows that the gap between the tract and city in this distribution has decreased from 2006 to 2021.

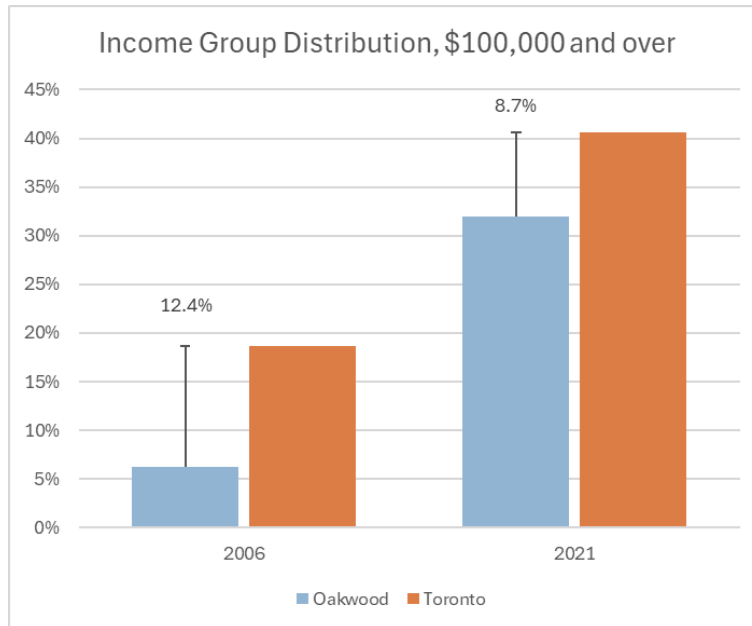


Figure 4. After-tax income group distribution of the \$100,000 and over category from 2006 to 2021, in Oakwood and Toronto. Point difference illustrated.

For the under 10k group, Figure 5 shows an alternate split of series by region rather than year because the more prominent difference is across region rather than time, since the proportion in Oakwood and Toronto remains almost equal across the years. For both regions, the proportion of those in the under 10k income group decreased from 2006 to 2021. In Oakwood, notably, the proposition decrease was greater by 1.0 percent point.

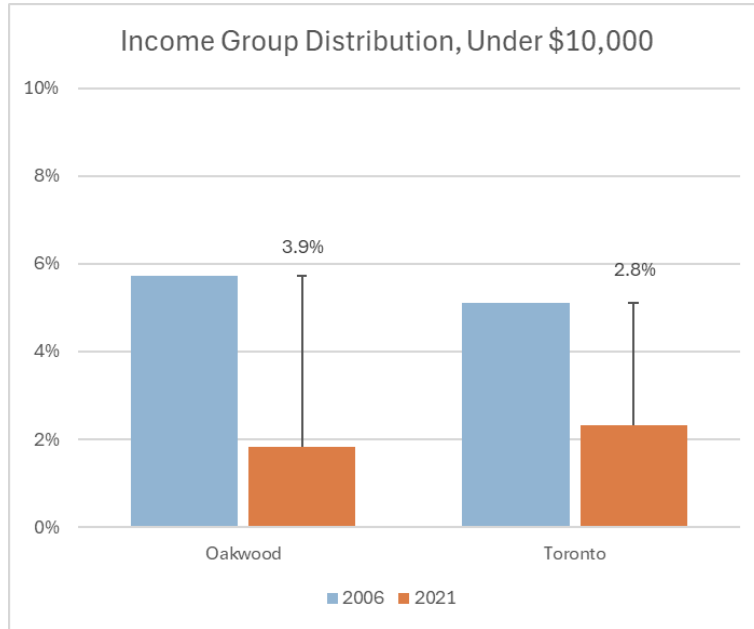


Figure 5. After-tax income group distribution of the Under \$10,000 category in Oakwood and Toronto, from 2006 to 2021. Point difference illustrated.

03C Wealth Inequity & Poverty

Comparing Gini indices in 2021 shows greater wealth equity in Oakwood (0.258) than Toronto (0.33).

In 2021, Oakwood and Toronto in total were basically equal in the total rate of low income (and therefore poverty) based on LIM-AT and LICO-AT indicators. However, the rates for the youngest and the oldest age groups were drastically different. As colored in blue in Table 1, children aged 0-5 have significantly less prevalence of low income based on these indicators in Oakwood over Toronto. This indicates that households raising children in Oakwood are less likely to be living in poverty. Colored in orange in Table 1, seniors aged 65+ have a significantly higher prevalence of low income and a higher likelihood of impoverishment.

	Oakwood (%)	Toronto (%)	Percent Difference (%)	Percent Point Difference (%)
Prevalence of low income based on the Low-income measure, after tax (LIM-AT) (%)				
Total	11.1	10.2	8.8	0.9
0 to 17 years	10.2	11.3	-9.7	-1.1
0 to 5 years	7	11.8	-40.7	-4.8
18 to 64 years	9.2	9.1	1.1	0.1
65 years and over	19	13.5	40.7	5.5
Prevalence of low income based on the Low-income cut-offs, after tax (LICO-AT) (%)				
Total	6.3	6.6	-4.5	0.3
0 to 17 years	4.8	5.9	-18.6	-1.1
0 to 5 years	4	6	-33.3	-2
18 to 64 years	6.7	7.3	-8.2	-0.6
65 years and over	6.6	4.5	46.7	2.1

Table 1. Prevalence of low income based on poverty indicators LIM-AT and LICO-AT, in 2021.

04 Labour Force Characteristics

04A Unemployment Rate

The unemployment rate almost doubled from 2006 to 2021 in both Oakwood and Toronto – 6.3 to 11.9 and 6.7 to 13.3 respectively. The rate is slightly less in the tract, a regional decrease of 10.5% in 2021.

04B Occupational and Industrial Distributions

The occupational distribution is similar comparing the tract and the city in 2021. The occupations with the highest distributions in Oakwood are (1) sales and service, (2) the trades, and (3) business, finance and administration (highest to lowest). Toronto has the same top 3,

though business and the trades switch. The lowest are (1) senior and legislative management, (2) natural resources and agriculture, (3) manufacturing, and (4) art (lowest to highest). In Toronto, the bottom four are occupied by the same occupational groups. Figure 6 illustrates the largest differences.

Considering Figure 7, the most prominent regional difference is that for senior and legislative management occupations (74.5% decrease) and sales occupations (49.0% increase). From 2006 to 2021, senior and legislative management occupations drastically decreased in both regions.

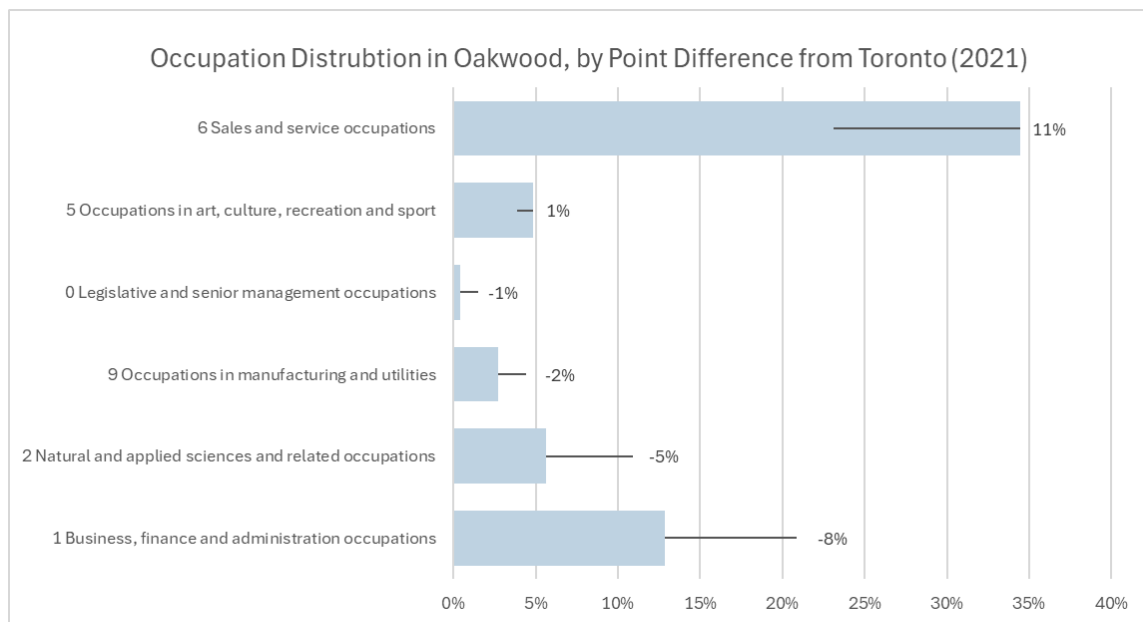


Figure 6. Occupation distribution in Oakwood, in 2021. Abridged, displaying occupation groups with five of the biggest percent differences. Percent point difference from Toronto distribution is illustrated.

The industry distribution in 2021 Oakwood ranks (1) retail, (2) health care and social assistance, and (3) construction. In Figure 7, the differences between Oakwood and Toronto in industry distribution are illustrated. In general, more work in construction and waste management and less work in finance/insurance and manufacturing.

From 2006 to 2021, the real estate industry experienced a huge increase in the tract (257.2% increase from 0.9% to 3.3%). The difference between Oakwood and Toronto in construction was greater in 2006 (187.2% increase) than in 2021 (57.7% increase).

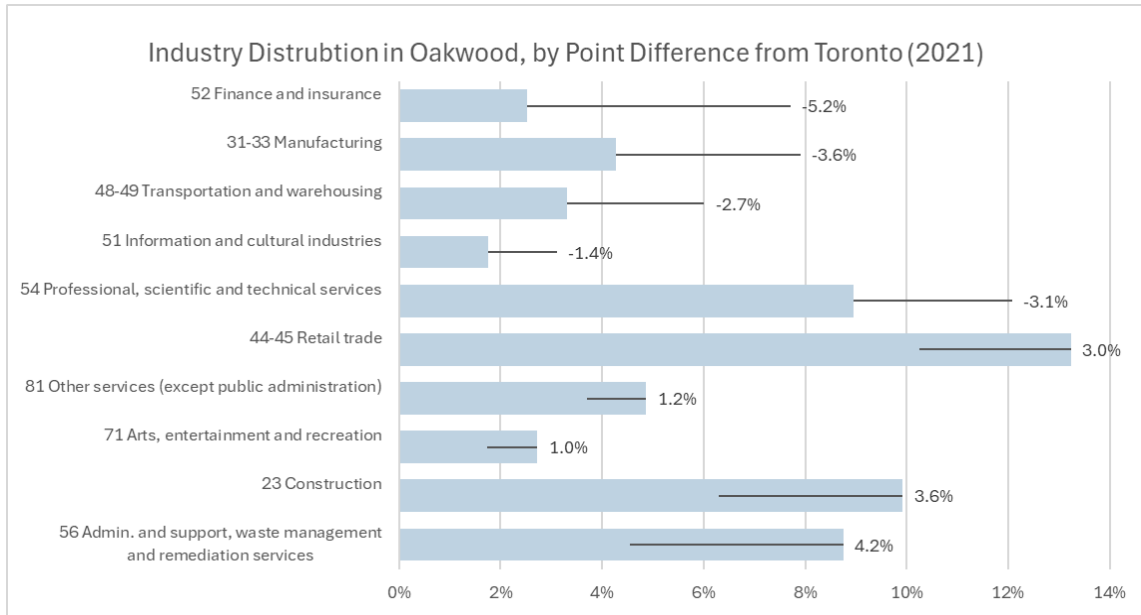


Figure 7. Industry distribution in Oakwood, in 2021. Abridged, displaying industry groups with ten most significant percent differences. Percent point difference from Toronto distribution is illustrated.

05 Dwelling Characteristics

05A Structural Type of Dwelling

Figure 8 illustrates the distribution of occupied structural types of dwellings in Oakwood and Toronto from 2006 to 2021. Temporally, Oakwood has seen an increase in both single and semi-detached houses and apartments with 1-4 storeys. Apartments with 5+ stories in Oakwood decreased drastically in occupation from 2006 to 2021, a 43.7% decrease; Toronto overall saw an increase of 15.6%.

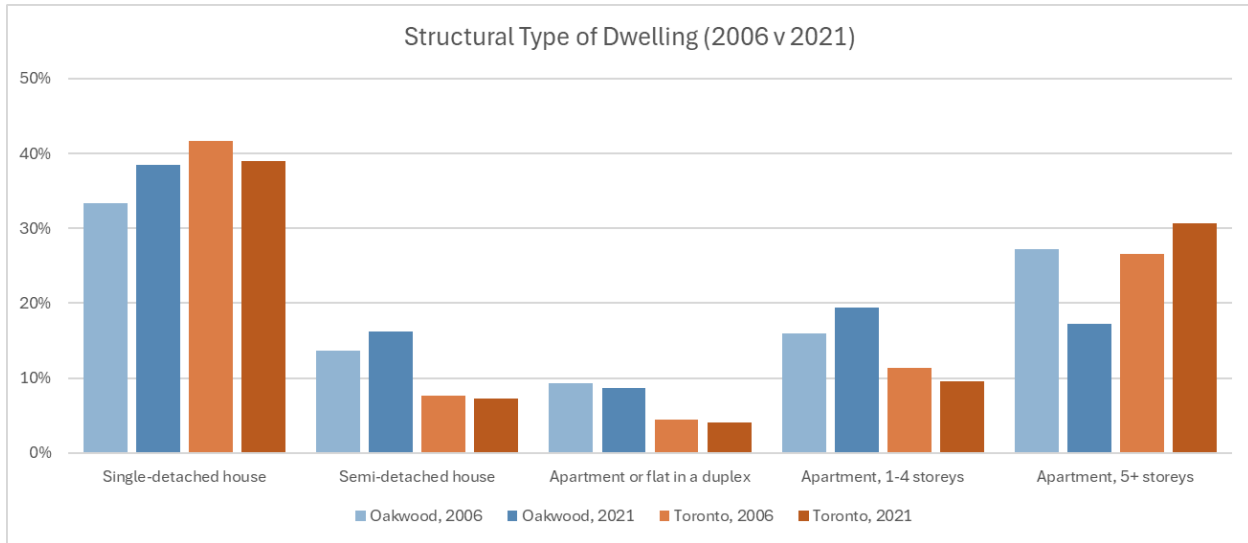


Figure 8. Abridged distribution of structural types of dwellings in Oakwood and Toronto in 2006 and 2021.

05B Age of Dwelling

The majority of dwellings occupied in the tract were constructed before 1960, far higher than Toronto in general (56.9% vs 18.2% respectively in 2021). In 2021, only 5.5% of Oakwood occupied dwellings were constructed in the 21st century – in Toronto, it was 31.9%. However, there is indication that more people are living in more recently constructed dwellings in the tract. In 2006, 0.5% dwellings from the last 5 years were occupied in Oakwood (11.5% in Toronto). In 2021, 2.3% from the last 5 years were occupied in Oakwood (7.9% in Toronto).

05C Cost of Dwelling

About 70% spend less than 30% of their income on shelter in a combination of owners and tenants in both Oakwood and Toronto. Significantly more tenants than owners spend more than 30% of their income on shelter – in Oakwood 2021, 19.6% of owners and 44.5% of renters. Compared to Toronto, this is a lesser portion of owners (25.2%) and a higher portion of renters (40.5%). This is an indication the dwelling-owner population has higher incomes than renters.

The average value of owners' dwellings is consistently less in Oakwood than Toronto. There was a difference of ~\$129,000 (24.7% decrease) in 2006 and a difference of \$148,000 (13.3% decrease) in 2021. Therefore, though the gap in absolute value increased, proportionally the gap

decreased. Both regions experienced more than a doubling in average value of dwellings from 2006 to 2021.

Average monthly rent had less drastic changes, regionally and over time. As shown in Table 2, average rent in Oakwood remained the same from 2006 and 2021. Though it was slightly more than Toronto average in 2006, Toronto average rent increased by 31.4% in 2021. Thus creating a sizable gap across regions over time.

	Oakwood (\$)	Toronto (\$)	Cross-region Difference (\$)	Percent Difference (%)
2006	1343	1231	112	9.1
2021	1372	1618	-246	-15.2
Cross-year Difference (\$)	29	387		
Percent Difference (%)	2.2	31.4		

Table 2. Average monthly rent for tenant households in Oakwood and Toronto, 2006 and 2021.

05D Other Characteristics

There are more renters in Oakwood compared to Toronto – in 2021: 45.2% in Oakwood, 34.9% in Toronto. The proportion was basically the same in 2006. A higher proportion of dwellings in the tract are regarded as “unsuitable” – in 2021: 12.3% in Oakwood, 10.3% in Toronto. No data from 2006.

Conclusions

Evaluating Oakwood in comparison to Toronto, there may be a link in the over-representation of underrepresented visible minorities and the larger proportions of lower income groups in the region (as well as the lower median income for households). The higher presence of Black, Filipino, and Latin American populations in a region with a lower median income than the city may indicate subjugation in underpaid racialized labor or barriers to entry into higher income. There is a higher portion of seniors over 85 in the region, which is connected to the disproportionately high indication of poverty among seniors.

The tract's lower income bracket is reflected in the high occupation of old dwellings and a lack of occupation in 21st-century dwellings – this may be an indication of the region attracting less development. The slight decrease/relative stability of the tract population while the Toronto population increased over 15 years supports this theory. Lower income is also reflected in the differences in the distribution of occupations & industries. Oakwood has a larger proportion of workers in lower income occupations such as sales and the arts, and a smaller proportion of workers in high income occupations in business and STEM.

From 2006 to 2021, there is a steady increase in income as well as an increase in more recent dwellings being occupied, with a higher portion occupying 1-4 storey buildings than in Toronto. This could hint at a recent turn for the better for the region, also hinted by (1) the proportionally closing gap in the average value of owned dwellings, (2) the evening out in income distribution to more closely match Toronto's, and (3) the increase in the +100k income group. Though monthly rent is controlled, more renters spend 30% of their income on shelter than owners in the tract. This is an indication of a smaller owner population that is wealthier than the greater renter population. This disparity is reflected in the temporal increase in the \$100k+ income group.

The stable rent in Oakwood is a unique advantage within Toronto. Its stability may be attributed to the tract containing more renters living in much older houses with less income and more strain on funding shelter. The region is older and has a higher portion of underrepresented visible minorities. The population stagnation means there is less strain on housing needs, which means less demand, and less cost to housing. There have been promising developments in income growth and dwelling upgrades that may attract support from private or public developers.